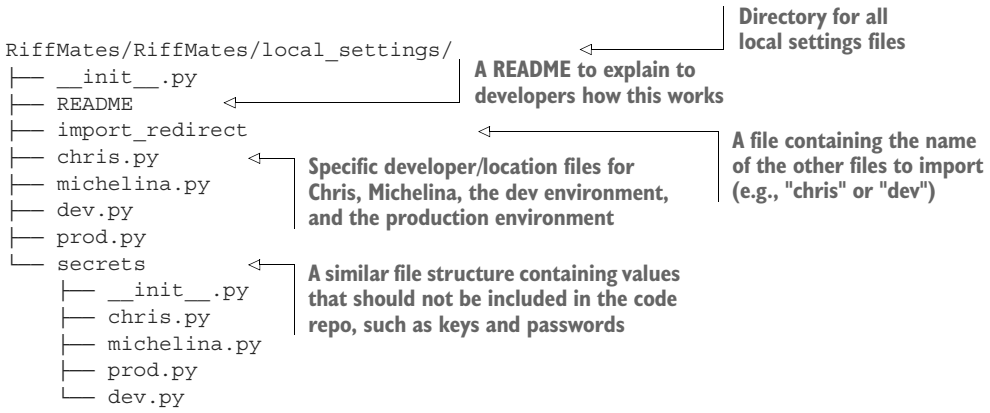
This is probably overkill for a small project, but when you have multiple environments and a team of developers, it allows you to set configuration values specific to both a deployment target and, if necessary, a developer. For example, if we were working together and you wanted to use the Django Debug Toolbar but I didn't, this would be possible because we'd both have our own configuration file. An example file tree looks like this:



The import_redirect file and the secrets directory aren't included in your code repo. Adding the following to `.gitignore` ensures they won't be committed accidentally:

```
# .gitignore
...
RiffMates/local_settings/import_redirect
RiffMates/local_settings/secrets/
```

The code in settings.py that does the importation work can be seen in the following listing.

Listing B.1 Code for dynamically importing local settings and secret modules

```
# RiffMates/RiffMates/settings.py
...
# ---- local settings import overrides

# detect if in dev server mode
import sys
DEV_SERVER = (len(sys.argv) > 1 and \
    sys.argv[1] == 'runserver')

redirect = (BASE_DIR /
    'RiffMates/local_settings/import_redirect')
with open(redirect, 'r') as f:
    import_file = f.read().strip()

action = 'from RiffMates.local_settings.%s import *' \
    % import_file
```

Detect if you're running the development server.

The file containing the name of other files to import

Read import_redirect, and get the name of the other imports.

Build the Python code that imports all values from the requested local settings file.